

US Business Services

US Business Services: Mid-year update and outlook for H2:26



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After a strong first half for Industrials broadly, traditional US Business Services stocks have lagged: our Waste coverage underperformed the S&P 500 by -8%, Cintas -13%, and Rollins the worst lagging -37%. Versus the Industrial sector underperformance is even worse. This is not a story of deteriorating fundamentals: EBITDA revisions are flat year-to-date for our Waste coverage and Cintas, albeit fundamentals for Rollins have come under concern. Rather, the market has rotated into higher-beta, pro-cyclical names—data center beneficiaries, PMI-sensitive industrials, etc.—leaving Waste and uniforms as relative laggards. There is some justification to this—for businesses with stable revisions they ought to underperform those with more positive ones.

We believe the Waste industry outlook has improved modestly since January. Fed 2026 CPI expectations have risen to 3.5% from 2.6%, and given that many contracts price on a 12-month average CPI with a 6-month lag, **FY2027 pricing estimates likely need to move higher. Recycled commodity prices are up year-to-date across OCC and plastics, D3 RIN prices are up 23% YoY, and with PMI above 50 for five consecutive months, industrial volumes offer near-term upside** compared to when PMI was 47.9 at the start of the year. The clearest risk is Residential, where volumes have stayed negative longer than management teams anticipated—Republic Services's CEO described industry competition as, "people willing to work for very, very low returns" on the last earnings call—though our base case is gradual improvement through H2:26. **It is probable the Waste industry increases FY2026 guidance during Q2 results.** Within Waste RSG and WM have performed the same year-to-date, with WCN lagging them by 7%, relating to concerns about the Chiquita Canyon landfill.

Industrial distributors have broadly outperformed the S&P 500, though dispersion is wide: Grainger is up +33%, Fastenal up +21%, and Ferguson up +3%. Grainger's outperformance reflects a catch-up from 2025 underperformance and stronger execution—and a beat and raised last quarter—while Fastenal was caught flat-footed on branded product pricing. Incoming CEO Jeff Watts begins in July, and execution risk related to his transition is an area of focus. Ferguson's lag is a residential construction story: May housing starts fell -15% MoM to the lowest level since May 2020, offsetting what we view as underappreciated data center exposure in the non-residential book.

For Pest Control and Uniforms, two near-term events define each company's setup. Rollins enters Q2:26 with its first clean organic growth read since Q3:25; intra-quarter commentary at a conference cited "choppy" trends linked to lower end consumer pressure in some areas of the business. Its competitor Rentokil (covered by Will Kirkness) was asked about this, and opted not to comment. There is one thing we can say for certain—weather was warmer YoY, a tailwind for pest control players entering the quarter. **Cintas remains in deal purgatory:** the FTC's June 11th Second Request likely pushes **any deal approval to H1:27**, most likely approved or not in its current form since divestitures would be an insufficient remedy to FTC concerns. **Near-term, investors are focused on whether incremental margins step up to 35-38% next quarter (FYQ4:26),** after several quarters near ~27%, providing clarity on whether lackluster margins were temporary or structural.

BERNSTEIN TICKER TABLE

Ticker	Rating	Cur	2 Jul 2026	Price Target	TTM Rel. Perf.	Adjusted EPS				Adjusted P/E (x)		
			Closing Price			Cur	2025A	2026E	2027E	2025A	2026E	2027E
CTAS (Cintas)	M	USD	181.37	200.00	(35.1)%	USD	4.40	4.89	5.40	41.2	37.1	33.6
FAST (Fastenal)	U	USD	48.60	42.00	(5.3)%	USD	1.09	1.21	1.31	44.4	40.3	37.2
FERG (Ferguson)	O	USD	230.24	310.00	(15.2)%	USD	10.58	11.38	12.60	21.8	20.2	18.3
FERG.LN (Ferguson)	O	GBP	17,140	22,963	(13.2)%	USD	10.58	11.38	12.60	21.6	20.1	18.2
RSG (Republic Services)	M	USD	217.34	220.00	(27.7)%	USD	7.02	7.19	8.07	30.9	30.2	26.9
ROL (Rollins)	M	USD	42.14	52.00	(43.4)%	USD	1.13	1.25	1.40	37.3	33.8	30.2
GWW (Grainger)	M	USD	1,342.98	1,250.00	10.5%	USD	39.48	45.72	49.63	34.0	29.4	27.1
WCN (Waste Connections)	O	USD	168.82	205.00	(24.4)%	USD	5.15	5.53	6.23	32.8	30.5	27.1
WM (Waste Management)	O	USD	230.40	260.00	(16.0)%	USD	7.56	8.26	9.23	15.1	14.1	12.9
SPX			7,483.24									

O - Outperform, M - Market-Perform, U - Underperform, NR - Not Rated, CS - Coverage Suspended

WM valuation is EV/Adj EBITDA (x);

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

INVESTMENT IMPLICATIONS

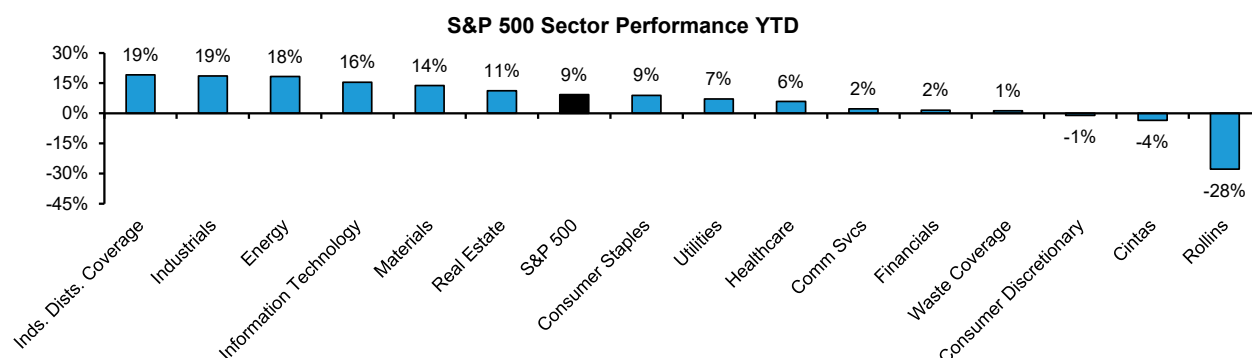
Within Waste, we rate Waste Management Outperform with a PT of \$260, Waste Connections Outperform with a PT of \$205, and Republic Services Market-Perform with a PT of \$220. With our Industrial Distributor coverage we rate Ferguson Outperform with a PT of \$310, WW Grainger Market-Perform with a PT of \$1,250, and Fastenal Underperform with a PT of \$42. We rate Cintas Market-Perform with a PT of \$200 and Rollins Market-Perform with a PT of \$52.

DETAILS

2026 BUSINESS SERVICES YTD PERFORMANCE

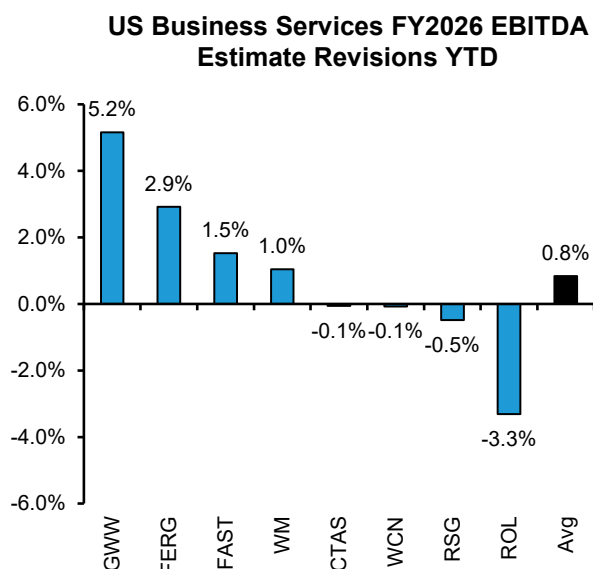
After a strong first half for Industrials broadly, traditional US Business Services stocks have lagged: our Waste coverage underperformed the S&P 500 by -8%, Cintas by -13%, and Rollins the worst lagging by -37% (Exhibit 1). Versus the Industrial sector underperformance is even worse. This is a not a story of deteriorating fundamentals: EBITDA revisions are flat year-to-date for our Waste coverage and Cintas, albeit fundamentals for Rollins have come under concern. Rather, the market has rotated into higher-beta, pro-cyclical names—data center beneficiaries, PMI-sensitive industrials, etc.—leaving Waste and uniforms as relative laggards. There is some justification to this—for businesses with stable outlooks, relative outperformance in revisions elsewhere, should drive share outperformance as well.

EXHIBIT 1: Industrial distributors performed the best in our US Business Services coverage year-to-date, outperforming the S&P 500 by -10%. Our Waste coverage, Cintas, and Rollins lagged the broader market.



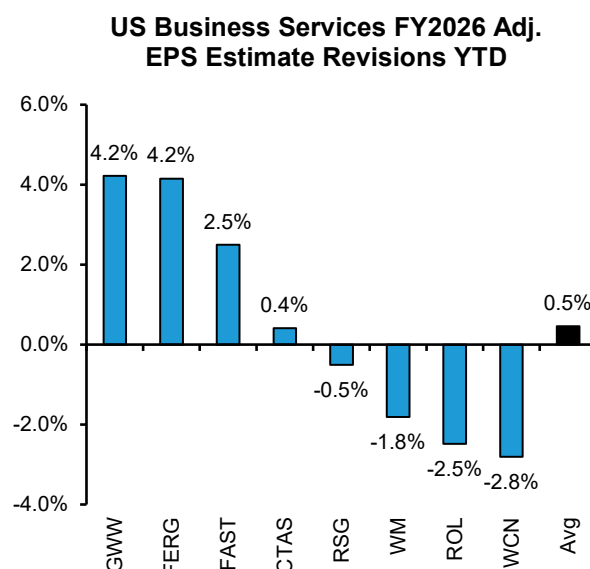
Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 2: Industrial distributors saw positive EBITDA revisions, increasing 3.2% on average YTD. EBITDA revisions were the worst for Rollins (-3.3%) and Waste estimate revisions are flattish.



Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 3: Industrial distributors EPS estimates increased 3-4% year-to-date while Waste estimates are flat to slightly down. Rollins EPS estimates declined -2.5% and Cintas estimates are flattish.



Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein analysis

US WASTE

Waste companies have lagged the S&P 500 by -8% despite flat to down estimate revisions across the group (Exhibit 4). The sector's underperformance is a reflection of a rotation within Industrials rather than weakening fundamentals. In an environment where PMI has inflected above 50 and data center construction activity continues to accelerate, it seems that investors have rotated out of stable, defensive Industrials and into higher-beta, economically sensitive names, leaving the Waste sector as a relative underperformer. Returns have varied across the top four waste players: WM and RSG are the best-performing companies within our Waste coverage up +4%, while WCN is down -4%, and GFL -13%. The underperformance of Waste Connections reflects ongoing Chiquita Canyon Landfill concerns and for GFL is related to investor's negative view of their bid for Secure Waste.

The pricing outlook for the industry has improved since the start of the year and FY2027 pricing estimates likely need to be revised modestly higher. Index-based contracts, which often use a 12-month average CPI on a 6-month lag, suggest 2026 pricing should average 2.7% for FY2026, unchanged year-to-date. However, Fed expectations for headline CPI increased to 3.5% from 2.6% since the start of the year, indicating consensus FY2027 estimates likely need to be revised modestly higher (Exhibit 5 - Exhibit 6).

Volume trends are mixed across end markets—weak in Residential, stable in Commercial, recovering in Industrial.

Residential volumes have stayed negative for several quarters, and management teams have repeatedly called for the trough only to see conditions deteriorate further or remain similarly negative (Exhibit 7). On their Q1:26 earnings call, Republic Services's CEO characterized the Residential environment as "very, very competitive," suggesting that the industry as a whole has underestimated competitive intensity across the group. Negative volumes in Residential are expected to persist for all three large companies but improve in the second half of 2026—we expect volumes to stay negative in 2027, but at an improving rate, and turn positive in 2028. Commercial volumes remain roughly flat, and we see upside to Industrial volumes in the back half of 2026 as PMI has been above 50 for five consecutive months (Exhibit 8). Q2:26 comparables are difficult for Waste Management and Republic Services due to wildfire and hurricane cleanup benefits in the prior year, while WCN is unimpacted.

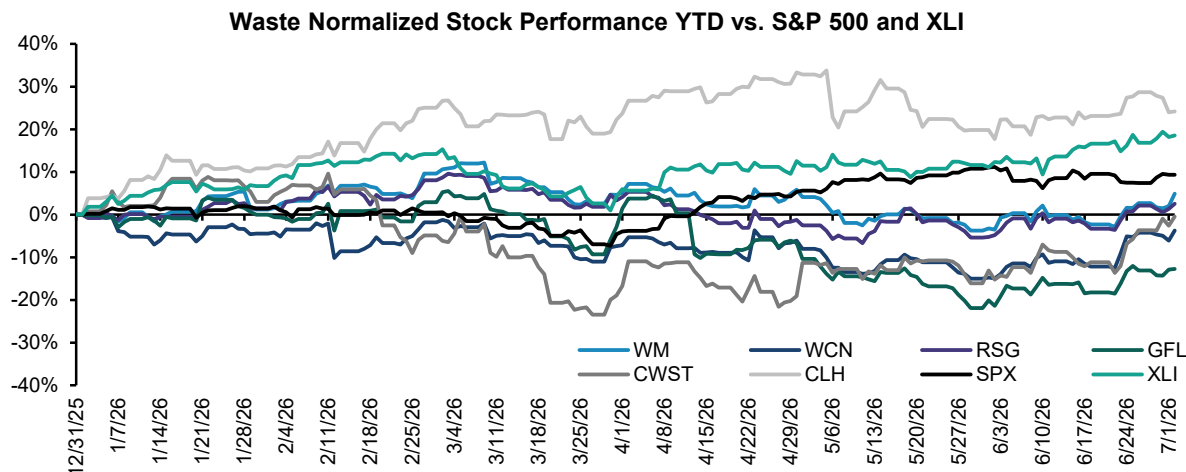
Higher recycled commodity prices year-to-date are a tailwind to the sector with Waste Connections and Republic Services expected to see the most upside in FY2026 guidance.

The recycling backdrop has improved meaningfully year-to-date, with both OCC and plastics pricing higher compared to January 2026 (Exhibit 9 - Exhibit 10). OCC is 60-70% of Recycling sales with pricing improving sequentially every month in 2026, close to flat YoY, driven by recovering box demand, containerboard capacity cuts, and export demand. Virgin plastic (~15% of sales) supply is tightening due to the Iran conflict resulting in higher pricing. Waste Connections and Republic Services are best positioned to benefit from higher commodity prices, while Waste Management has already embedded a recycling recovery into its full-year guidance. Automation investments are an additional benefit to the Recycling business. Waste Management is targeting 300bps EBITDA margin improvement in the Recycling segment in FY2026, and Republic Services Polymer Center produce higher-quality product and can partially offset price weakness.

Underpinned by improving sector fundamentals we see a reasonable probability that Republic Services and Waste Connections increase FY2026 guidance during Q2:26 results. Waste Management is slightly less likely to increase guidance in our view as the improvement in recycled commodity prices is already factored into FY2026 guidance.

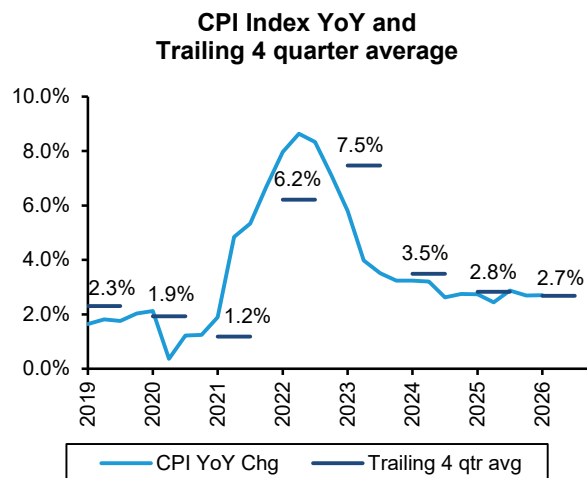
Valuation remains attractive and, in our view, does not reflect the improvement in fundamentals compared to the start of the year. Our Waste coverage trades near its ten-year average on an absolute EV/NTM EBITDA basis but at decade lows relative to the S&P 500 at 1.0x and 0.8x on NTM P/FCF (Exhibit 11 - Exhibit 12). Bears argue that incremental growth from recycling and RNG investments is lower quality than core municipal solid waste (MSW) collection and disposal, warranting a lower multiple. We view this concern as overblown and expect core MSW to continue to represent the majority of sales for the average waste company. At decade-low relative valuations with room for EBITDA estimate revisions and a more constructive setup heading into H2:26, we believe the risk/reward skews positively for the Waste sector.

EXHIBIT 4: Waste stock performance for our coverage (WM, WCN and RSG) is roughly flat year-to-date, underperforming the S&P 500 and XLI. Stable, defensive Industrials names remain out of favor in a higher PMI and stronger data center environment



Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 5: Fed 2026 headline CPI expectations increased to 3.5% from 2.6% since the start of the year. Combined with recent higher- than-expected CPI, this suggests FY2027 pricing will likely be higher than FY2026.



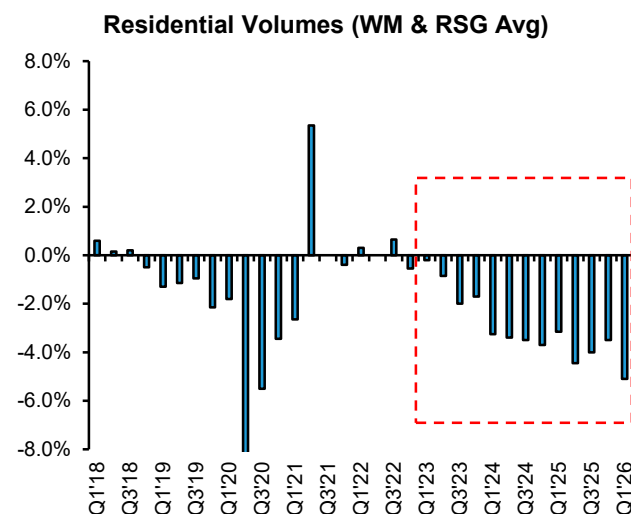
Source: US Bureau of Labor Statistics, Bloomberg, Bernstein analysis and estimates

EXHIBIT 6: FY2026 pricing for contracts based on alternative indices such as CPI for Waste Sewer Trash is expected to be slightly higher than FY2025



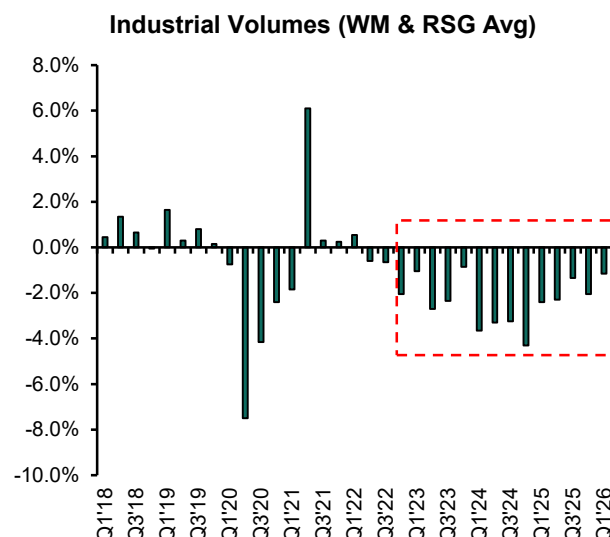
Source: US Bureau of Labor Statistics, Bloomberg, Bernstein analysis and estimates

EXHIBIT 7: Negative volumes in Residential are expected to persist through 2026, with potential modest improvement in H2:26 for WM, and for RSG in Q4:26 and into FY2027



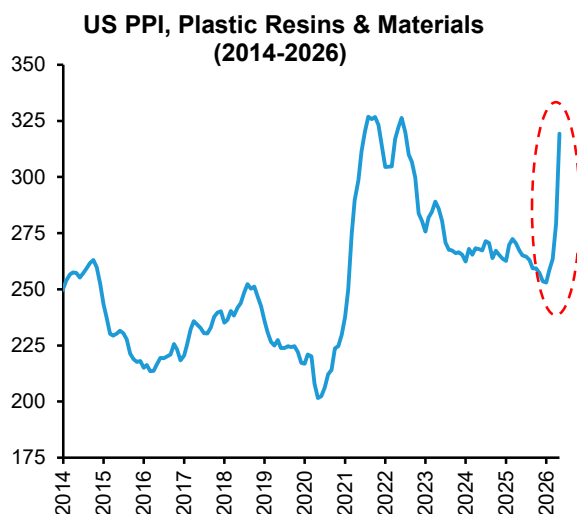
Source: Company filings, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 8: The Industrial volume outlook continues to improve with PMI above 50 for five consecutive months. We see upside to volumes in the back half of 2026



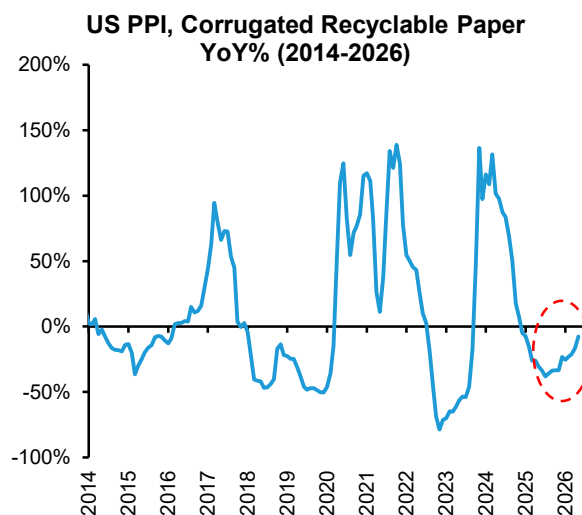
Source: Company filings, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 9: The US PPI for Plastics Materials and Resins inflected in May. Virgin plastic supply is tightening due to the Iran conflict, resulting in higher pricing that should in turn lift recycled plastic prices



Source: Bloomberg, Company filings, US Bureau of Labor Statistics, FRED, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 10: Declines in the US PPI for old corrugated paper moderated in April and May, with a strong improvement in pricing YTD



Source: Bloomberg, Company filings, US Bureau of Labor Statistics, FRED, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 11: The average EV/NTM EBITDA multiple for our Waste coverage is in line with its 10-year average on an absolute basis...

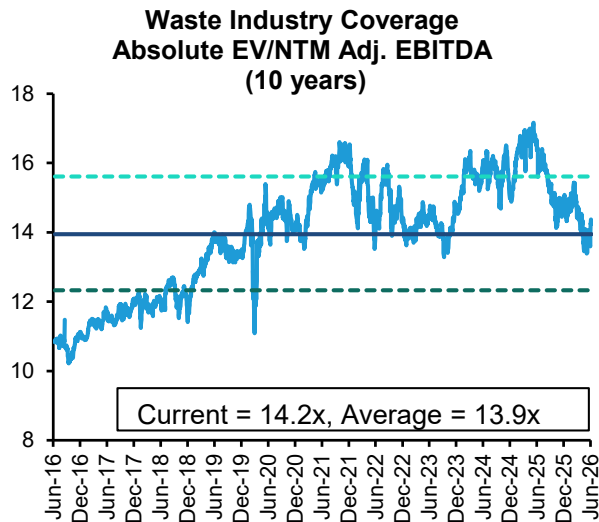
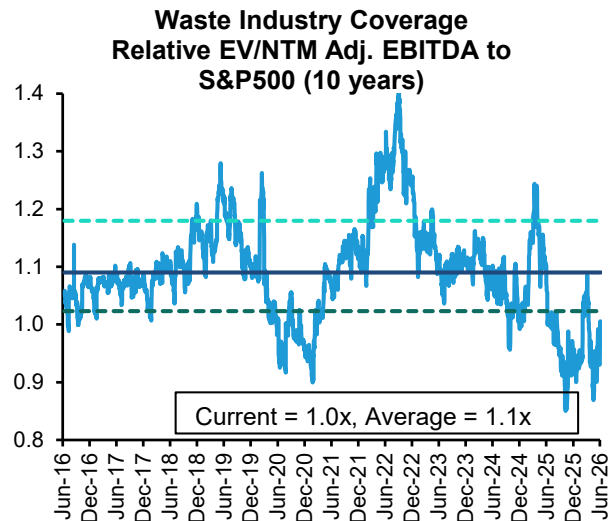


EXHIBIT 12: but near decade lows versus the market at ~1.0x EV/NTM EBITDA relative to the S&P 500.



Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein analysis

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein analysis

US INDUSTRIAL DISTRIBUTORS

Industrial distributors have broadly outperformed the S&P 500 and the XLI year-to-date, but stock-level performance has varied reflecting differences in end market exposure and execution (Exhibit 13). Grainger (+33%) performed the best in our coverage year-to-date, followed by Fastenal up +21%, and Ferguson up +3%. Wesco (not covered) and Ferguson have traded as mirror images following Q1:26 earnings, raising a question of whether investors are rotating into Wesco as the preferred data center proxy among the industrial distributors. Core & Main (not covered) is down -14% which we believe is due to weak residential construction activity with limited data center offset. The divergence in stock performance across the group is a function of end-market mix, reflecting different exposure to residential headwinds, non-residential and data center tailwinds, and improving manufacturing activity.

The macro backdrop for industrial distributors has improved materially since January 2026. PMI has been above 50 for five consecutive months, compared to 48 exiting 2025 (Exhibit 14). Non-residential construction remains robust driven by a large commercial project pipeline and data center construction (Exhibit 15). On the other hand residential construction activity has worsened since January, a negative for Ferguson's guide which originally struck us as conservative, but is now likely more fair. Housing starts declined -15% MoM in May 2026 to ~1.2m, the lowest level since May 2020, as mortgage rates and affordability constraints continue to weigh on new construction (Exhibit 16). Existing home sales were ~3.8m in May 2026 and remain near 20-year lows (Exhibit 17).

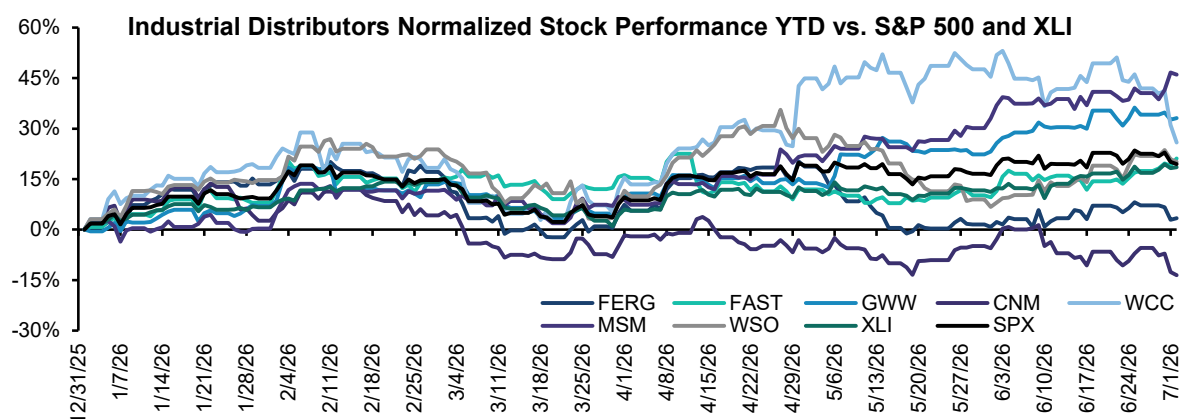
Grainger is the best-performing distributor in our coverage year-to-date, driven in part by a recovery from its relative underperformance versus Fastenal in 2025. Underlying fundamentals have been stronger at Grainger, with a Q1:26 beat and raise, disciplined tariff-related pricing execution, and no impact from the branded product pricing pressures that weighed on Fastenal. Pre-quiet period conversations suggest the company has not seen incremental disruption from conflict in Iran, and pricing conversations appear healthy despite supply chain pressure from the Middle East. Monotaro, reported at GWW on a one-month lag, implies Q2:26 growth above 20%, partly reflecting pull-forward buying ahead of the Iran War—an attractive setup for Q2:26. Our broader concern on Grainger remains unchanged: consensus appears to be extrapolating gross margin improvement from 2020-23, calling for flat gross margins as the new norm breaking a decade-long pre-pandemic trend of structural declines. We remain cautious and model modest 30bps gross margin expansion in FY2026 followed by -20bps declines annually through FY2028, which could weigh modestly on EPS expectations.

Pricing execution is the main debate for Fastenal, as the company faces both leadership transition risk and challenging customer negotiations. Q1:26 results fell short of consensus expectations as lower visibility on branded products and slower-than-expected pricing negotiations weighed on pricing and margins. At our Strategic Decisions Conference at the end of May,

CEO Daniel Florness acknowledged that the CFO transition may have delayed the internal escalation process that would have triggered earlier pricing actions. The company has been transparent about pricing missteps and appears to be working on resolving them, but balanced commentary makes it difficult to measure how quickly it will translate into better numbers. The broader execution concern for Fastenal is whether the CEO transition in July could introduce incremental risk at a time when pricing discipline remains critical. While the structural focus on digital penetration and larger customers remains strong, near-term pricing execution is a risk and we remain skeptical of consensus gross margin expectations following a period of higher tariff-driven pricing.

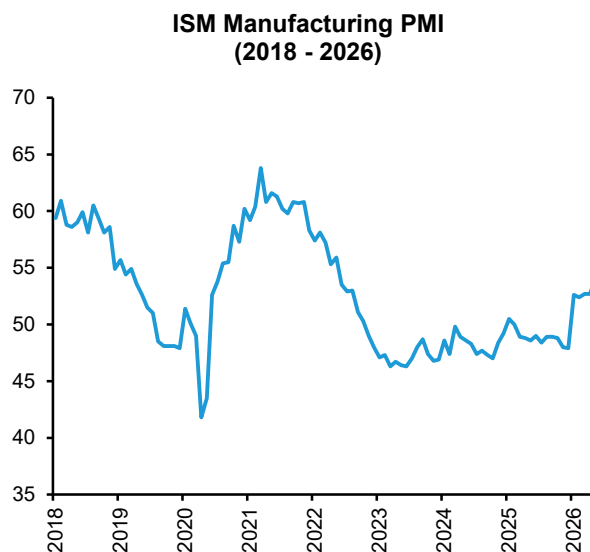
Ferguson is the laggard within our distributor coverage year-to-date, which we believe stems from weak residential construction activity partially offsetting non-residential strength. Ferguson holds the #1 or #2 position in 75% of its markets, and with approximately 20% market share in commercial plumbing and 5% in commercial HVAC it is the largest beneficiary of ongoing data center construction within our coverage. We believe this data center tailwind remains underappreciated by consensus. Together we expect the outlook for Ferguson to improve as non-residential activity strengthens and the residential headwind, while persistent, is well-understood and largely priced in.

EXHIBIT 13: Within our coverage GWW performed the best following strong Q1:26 results and increased FY2026 guidance above consensus expectations due to stronger demand and pricing. FAST was in line with the XLI due to pricing concerns, while FERG underperformed - is this due to a DC-related rotation into WCC?



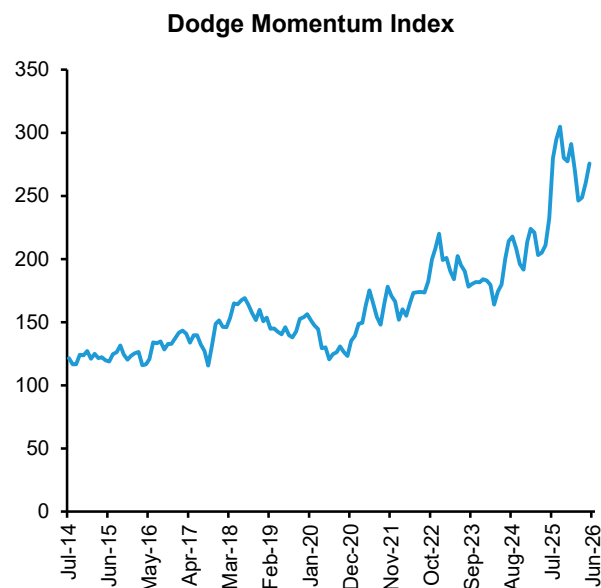
Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 14: PMI has been above 50 for five consecutive months



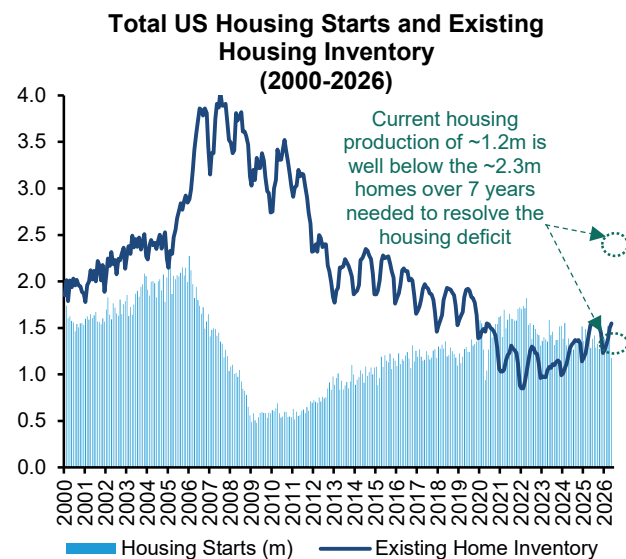
Source: ISM, Bloomberg, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 15: The Dodge Momentum Index indicates an improving non-residential construction backdrop



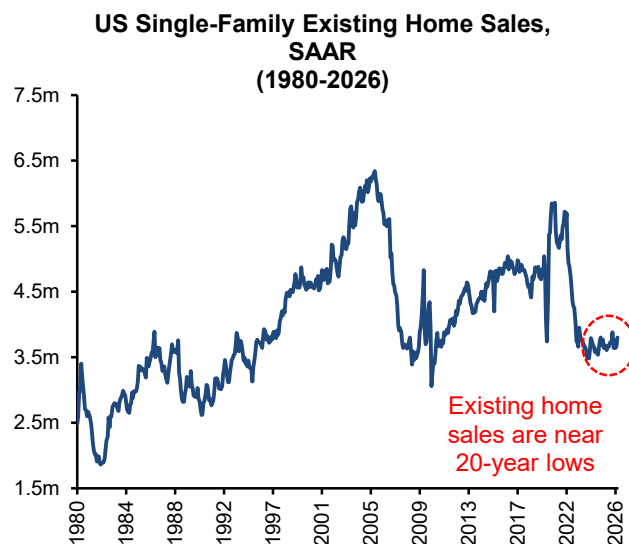
Source: Dodge, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 16: US Residential housing starts continue to decline, now at 1.2m SAAR—the lowest since May 2020—and below the ~2.3m needed to resolve the housing deficit



Source: National Association of Realtors, Bloomberg, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 17: Existing home sales are near 20-year lows indicating a lackluster housing market



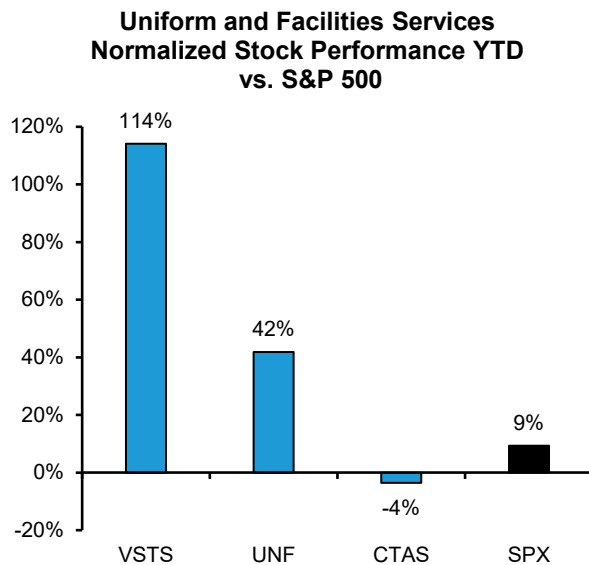
Source: National Association of Realtors, Federal Reserve St. Louis, Bloomberg, Bernstein analysis

CINTAS & ROLLINS

Cintas is down -4% year-to-date and, in our view, is stuck in deal purgatory until the UniFirst (not covered) acquisition is resolved (Exhibit 18). The fundamentals have been healthy, although investors have been disappointed by Cintas's margin progress over the last year. Incremental margins over the last 12 months have averaged 27% as the company invested in technology, on the low end of their 25-35% target range (Exhibit 19). Management has guided to 35-38% incremental margins in FYQ4:26, the first quarter lapping a full year of technology investments. Those results should provide clarity on whether lackluster margins were timing-related or structural.

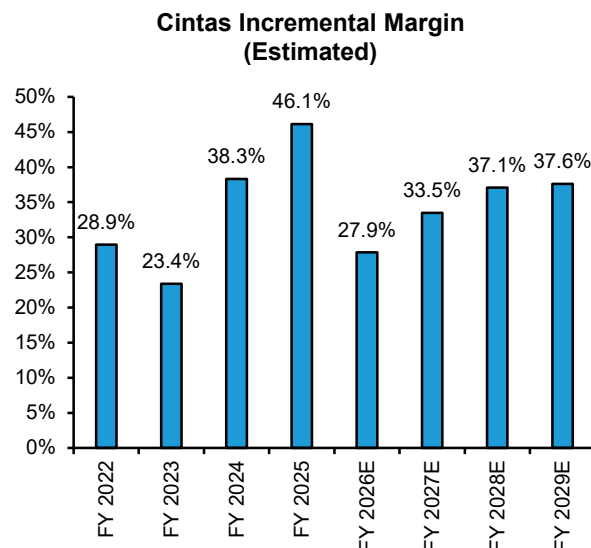
The Federal Trade Commission (FTC) issued a Second Request on June 11, 2026, likely pushing any approval to H1:27 at the earliest against management's expectation of H2:26 (Exhibit 20). The market implies a 75-80% probability of deal approval, above the 40-75% range we have heard from legal experts, and we believe the outcome of the deal will likely be binary (Exhibit 21). If FTC concerns center around the lack of a national player, divestments would need to be so significant that it would be unacceptable to Cintas. If it is local market concerns, the store overlap between Cintas and UniFirst would have to be so large that similarly significant divestments would be required. If the FTC challenges the deal, we believe the odds of Cintas winning in court are unlikely and the process would extend into late 2027.

EXHIBIT 18: Is Cintas stuck in deal purgatory as it awaits approval of the UNF acquisition? The stock sold off in March with the market and has yet to recover.



Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 19: Management expects a step up in incremental margins to 35-38% in FYQ4:26—consistent with 2H:26 guidance—but we believe will be difficult to achieve as Cintas laps tough comps of 50-60% margins



Source: Company filings, Bernstein analysis and estimates

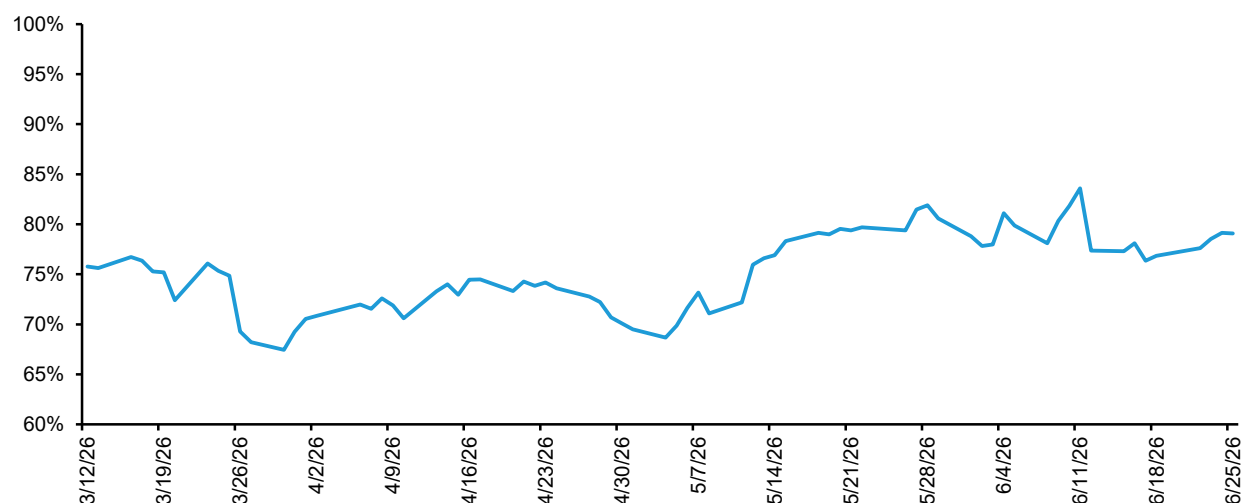
EXHIBIT 20: **Cintas/UniFirst HSR Regulatory Timeline**

Cintas / UniFirst — HSR Regulatory Timeline		
Milestone	Date	Status
Merger agreement signed	March 10, 2026	Complete
HSR initial filing	April 8, 2026	Complete
Cintas voluntary HSR withdrawal	May 8, 2026	Complete
Cintas HSR refile	May 12, 2026	Complete
UniFirst shareholder vote	June 11, 2026	Approved
FTC Second Request issued	On or before June 11, 2026	Issued
Second 30-day FTC window opens	After substantial compliance	Pending
Base termination date	January 10, 2027	
Extension 1 — antitrust delay	May 10, 2027	
Extension 2 — antitrust delay	September 10, 2027	
Expected close (company guidance)	H2 2026	

Source: Company filings (Cintas/UniFirst 424B3), Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 21: **Experts' deal approval odds range from 40-75%, with the market currently implying 75-80%. If the FTC challenges the deal, the odds of overturning it in court are low, with the issue dragging out until September 2027.**

CTAS / UNF Implied Deal Approval (%)



Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein analysis

Rollins has been the worst performing company in our coverage year-to-date, declining -28% vs. the S&P500 of +9%

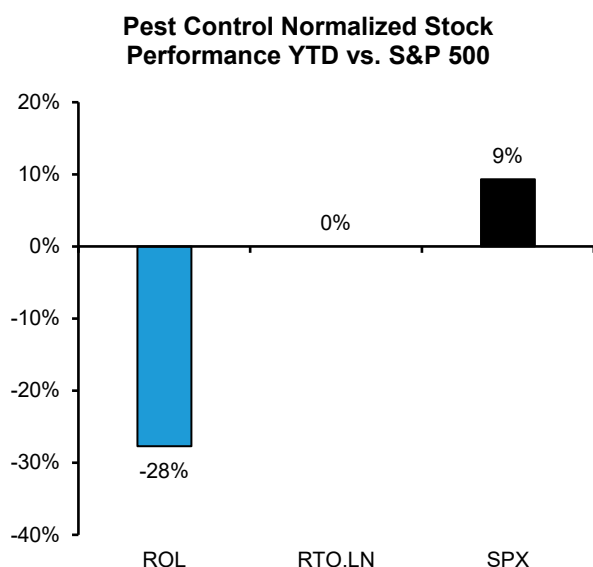
(Exhibit 22). The company reported weaker-than-expected Q4:25 results related to weather issues, while neither Rentokil nor Ecolab made similar commentary—note, 70-75% of Rollins stores have a Terminix store within a 15-mile radius. Rollins also reported weather issues in Q1:26, this time more legitimate given frequent blizzards, but had a healthy exit rate for the quarter with 8.4% organic growth in March. A separate concern, which we give less credence to, was the FTC's decision to cease enforcement of non-compete policies in the Pest Control industry. This coincided with Rollins's May investor day, where former CFO Ken Krause laid out a margin outlook primarily predicated on lower employee turnover. Two weeks after the investor day, Krause—the architect of Rollins's modernization plan—resigned after only three years at the company to take a leadership role in a different industry. More recently, intra-quarter commentary at a conference cited "choppy" trends linked to lower-end consumer pressure in parts of the business.

The US Business Services industry as a whole had already de-rated meaningfully ahead of Rollins's sell-off, which may have added to the stock's multiple compression. Cintas de-rated from ~50x NTM P/E to ~30x, ADP ~30x NTM P/E to ~20x (not covered), and consulting/information services companies like Gartner, Verisk, Equifax (all not covered) saw multiples fall by -50% or more. While these are different businesses in different end markets, they are surprisingly correlated at times, likely

a function of overlapping investor bases and share “quality compounder” positioning. Did the sector wide de-rating amplify Rollins’s multiple compression?

Q2:26 is the first quarter since Q3:25 with a clean organic growth read, and we expect weather to be a benefit as this spring experienced warmer than average temperatures (Exhibit 23). The CFO departure is a more medium- to long-term risk. Krause was the architect of the SG&A cost discipline underpinning the 30-35% incremental margin targets, and his replacement has been at the company less than a year. We believe the probability of executing on the medium-term margin roadmap has declined, which is the basis for our downgrade to Market Perform the day after Rollins announced Krause’s departure (Exhibit 24).

EXHIBIT 22: Rollins lagged due to weather issues weighing on the one-time business, intra-quarter comments pointing to weak demand, and the departure of former CFO Ken Krause



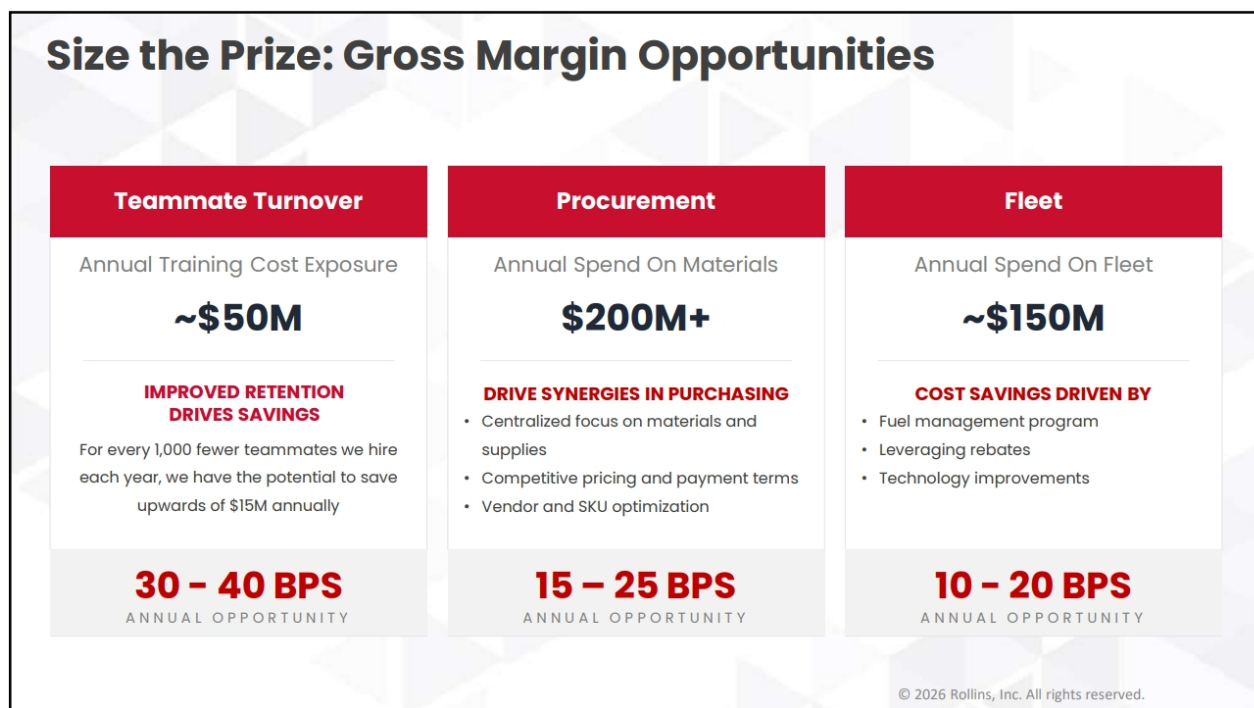
Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 23: Q2:26 is the first quarter since Q3:25 with a clean organic growth read, and we expect weather to be a benefit as this spring experienced warmer than average temperatures

Q2:26 Weather - Apr-May vs. 20th-Century Avg		
Region	Apr	May
Ohio Valley	+6.5F	-0.3F
Southwest	+5.0F	+3.2F
Southeast	+2.6F	+1.5F
Northeast	+2.9F	+0.2F
Midwest	+3.5F	+0.3F
Pacific NW / Mtn	+1.3F	+3.2F
California/Nevada	+3.2F	+2.7F
Northern Plains	+0.1F	+1.0F

Source: NOAA NCEI, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 24: At Rollins's May investor day, former CFO Ken Krause presented a margin expansion roadmap that implied 55-85bps of gross margin expansion, consistent with our prior thesis that the company could achieve 50-60bps of EBITDA margin expansion over the next 3-4 years. This target was not a FY2026 story but a FY2027 or later goal as incremental margins of 30-35% remained elusive. With the plan in its early stages, or at least newly announced, execution is critical, and with a new CFO we believe the odds of achieving these goals are now lower.



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Source: Rollins Investor Day 2026

BERNSTEIN SOCIÉTÉ GÉNÉRALE GROUP		FINANCIAL DATA																																						
		FY 2019		FY 2020		FY 2021		FY 2022		FY 2023		FY 2024		Q1'25		Q2'25		Q3'25		Q4'25		FY 2025		Q1'26		Q2'26		Q3'26		Q4'26		FY 2026		FY 2027E		FY 2028E		FY 2029E		
Income Statement																																								
Revenue		10,300	10,151	11,296	13,510	14,965	16,032	4,009	4,235	4,212	4,136	16,592	4,113	4,311	4,372	4,347	17,142	18,128	19,067	20,067																				
Cost of operations		6,299	6,101	6,739	8,200	8,942	9,350	2,314	2,449	2,463	2,404	9,630	2,366	2,510	2,560	2,517	9,953	10,451	10,916	11,408																				
Gross Profit		4,001	4,053	4,557	5,310	6,022	6,682	1,695	1,786	1,749	1,732	6,962	1,747	1,801	1,812	1,829	7,189	7,677	8,151	8,659																				
Depreciation, Depletion and Amortization		1,041	1,076	1,185	1,352	1,501	1,677	434	463	459	458	1,814	461	472	478	483	1,893	2,009	2,119	2,246																				
Selling, general and administrative		1,092	1,053	1,198	1,457	1,609	1,675	427	425	422	437	1,711	425	427	432	438	1,662	1,750	1,822	1,891																				
Operating Income (Recurring)		1,775	1,830	2,111	2,488	2,848	3,194	806	870	895	808	3,379	830	875	933	879	3,517	3,802	4,095	4,410																				
Adjusted EBITDA		2,910	2,989	3,384	3,929	4,447	4,979	1,268	1,361	1,383	1,295	5,307	1,321	1,374	1,440	1,390	5,526	5,927	6,330	6,762																				
Interest expense, net		386	350	312	392	502	531	138	143	143	141	566	149	148	149	151	596	573	543	497																				
Income before income taxes (Recurring)		1,282	1,362	1,614	1,928	2,261	2,417	667	729	704	572	2,672	657	725	728	636	2,745	3,027	3,349	3,710																				
Income tax expense		222	173	283	344	460	386	170	170	95	19	454	131	165	167	144	607	671	742	823																				
Net Income (Recurring)		1,065	1,139	1,331	1,583	1,777	2,032	496	556	594	547	2,193	526	573	575	541	2,214	2,442	2,703	2,994																				
EPS, Diluted (Recurring)		\$3.31	\$3.56	\$4.17	\$4.93	\$5.61	\$6.45	\$1.58	\$1.57	\$1.90	\$1.76	\$7.02	\$1.70	\$1.85	\$1.87	\$1.77	\$7.19	\$8.07	\$8.98	\$10.24																				
Diluted shares outstanding		322	320	319	317	317	315	313	313	312	310	312	309	309	307	306	308	303	298	292																				
Tax Rate (Adjusted)		16.9%	16.4%	17.5%	18.9%	21.4%	15.9%	25.6%	23.7%	15.6%	4.1%	17.9%	19.9%	21.0%	21.0%	15.0%	19.4%	19.3%	20.3%	19.																				

EXHIBIT 28: **Ferguson (FERG) Financials**

BERNSTEIN SOCIÉTÉ GÉNÉRALE GROUP		Financial Performance (in millions of U.S. dollars)																						
		FY 2019					FY 2020					FY 2021					FY 2022					FY 2023		
		Q1'19	Q2'19	Q3'19	Q4'19	Q1'20	Q2'20	Q3'20	Q4'20	Q1'21	Q2'21	Q3'21	Q4'21	Q1'22	Q2'22	Q3'22	Q4'22	Q1'23	Q2'23	Q3'23	Q4'23			
Income Statement																								
Net Sales		19,729	19,940	22,702	28,566	29,734	29,818	7,213	8,363	8,245	7,495	31,316	7,472	8,781	8,719	7,926	32,598	34,872	36,964	39,182				
Cost of Goods Sold		13,822	13,957	15,812	19,810	20,700	20,774	4,997	5,750	5,662	5,199	21,608	5,154	6,095	6,049	5,444	22,791	24,132	25,543	27,037				
Gross Profit		5,907	5,983	6,980	8,756	9,025	9,044	2,216	2,613	2,583	2,296	9,708	2,318	2,687	2,670	2,482	10,107	10,740	11,421	12,146				
Selling, general and administrative expenses		4,261	4,329	4,732	5,635	6,045	6,139	1,565	1,850	1,840	1,610	6,465	1,607	1,715	1,699	1,663	6,684	7,050	7,437	7,863				
Depreciation and amortization		200	202	208	301	321	351	93	96	96	95	380	99	118	107	100	400	471	490	520				
Operating Income (Recurring)		1,539	1,587	2,092	2,951	2,917	2,705	507	960	883	625	3,031	647	918	896	603	3,153	3,400	3,677	3,955				
Adjusted EBITDA		1,689	1,752	2,259	3,133	3,105	2,905	651	963	943	686	3,243	711	997	974	764	3,446	3,714	4,010	4,307				
Interest expense (net)		72	83	89	111	104	179	46	49	47	40	149	45	47	42	47	160	173	183	191				
Income before income taxes (Recurring)		1,463	1,452	1,970	2,859	2,722	2,523	559	854	830	563	2,896	596	886	847	640	2,950	3,197	3,493	3,810				
Income Taxes		0	308	452	702	684	640	144	218	204	152	718	151	221	208	173	753	817	893	973				
Net Income (Recurring)		1,122	1,144	1,518	2,157	2,038	1,883	415	636	626	411	2,188	445	664	639	467	2,196	2,380	2,601	2,836				
EPS, Diluted (Recurring)		\$4.64	\$4.04	\$4.75	\$6.76	\$6.04	\$5.33	\$2.08	\$3.22	\$3.18	\$2.10	\$10.58	\$2.26	\$3.34	\$3.32	\$2.46	\$11.38	\$12.03	\$13.03	\$14.61				
Diluted shares outstanding		232	227	225	219	207	202	199	198	197	196	197	195	194	192	191	193	189	185	182				
Tax Rate (Adjusted)		0.0%	21.2%	22.9%	24.7%	25.1%	25.4%	25.8%	25.5%	24.6%	27.0%	25.6%	25.4%	25.5%	24.4%	27.0%	25.5%	25.9%	25.5%	25.6%				
Margin Analysis																								
Gross Margin		29.9%	30.0%	30.6%	30.7%	30.4%	30.3%	30.7%	31.2%	31.3%	30.6%	31.0%	31.0%	30.6%	30.6%	30.7%	30.7%	30.8%	30.9%	31.0%				
EBIT Margin		7.8%	8.0%	9.2%	10.3%	9.8%	9.1%	8.3%	10.8%	10.7%	8.3%	9.6%	8.7%	10.4%	10.3%	8.7%	9.6%	9.8%	9.9%	10.1%				
EBITDA Margin		8.6%	8.8%	9.9%	11.0%	10.4%	9.7%	9.0%	11.5%	11.4%	9.2%	10.4%	9.5%	11.3%	11.2%	9.6%	10.5%	10.7%	10.8%	11.0%				
Net Profit Margin		5.7%	5.7%	6.7%	7.5%	6.9%	6.3%	6.8%	7.6%	7.6%	5.5%	6.7%	5.9%	7.4%	7.3%	5.9%	6.7%	6.8%	7.0%	7.2%				
Year-on-Year Growth																								
Net Sales		8.5%	1.1%	14.3%	25.3%	4.1%	-	3.0%	6.6%	6.6%	3.6%	5.0%	3.6%	5.0%	5.7%	5.8%	5.1%	6.0%	6.0%	6.0%				
Gross Profit		8.7%	1.3%	16.7%	25.4%	3.1%	-	3.2%	11.1%	7.8%	6.9%	7.3%	4.6%	2.8%	3.4%	5.9%	4.1%	6.3%	6.3%	6.3%				
Operating Income (Recurring)		8.4%	3.1%	31.8%	41.1%	1.2%	-	4.0%	18.5%	15.0%	13.8%	11.3%	8.4%	1.3%	1.4%	10.8%	4.7%	7.5%	8.1%	7.6%				
Adjusted EBITDA		8.8%	3.3%	28.7%	36.6%	-1.5%	-	-3.0%	18.5%	15.0%	14.1%	11.6%	9.2%	3.3%	3.3%	11.4%	6.3%	7.8%	8.0%	7.4%				
EPS, Diluted (Recurring)		-5.9%	4.2%	33.9%	44.6%	0.8%	-	-2.2%	21.3%	19.8%	11.7%	13.4%	9.3%	3.6%	4.4%	16.4%	7.6%	10.7%	11.4%	11.2%				
Balance Sheet																								
Cash and cash equivalents		-	2,115	1,335	771	601	722	-	407	832	557	557	820	1,050	1,484	1,468	1,468	1,801	2,321	3,043				
Total Assets		-	13,825	13,766	15,881	15,901	16,491	-	17,642	18,162	17,152	17,789	17,899	10,454	17,761	17,817	18,727	19,995	21,544	23,144				
Total Liabilities		-	3,166	2,564	3,929	3,768	798	-	3,577	4,124	4,126	4,126	4,126	4,127	4,127	4,127	4,127	4,127	4,127	4,127				
Other liabilities		-	6,050	6,199	7,067	7,191	7,260	-	8,339	8,025	7,169	7,169	7,788	8,100	8,085	7,421	7,421	7,643	7,876	8,124				
Total shareholders' equity		-	4,609	5,003	4,665	5,037	5,433	5,423	5,726	5,997	5,857	5,857	5,874	6,052	6,242	6,213	6,213	6,958	7,903	9,064				
Net working capital		-	2,297	2,092	3,231	3,102	3,276	-	3,447	3,774	4,002	4,002	3,795	3,749	3,521	3,475	3,475	3,770	4,084	4,416				
Consolidated Statement of Cash Flows																								
Cash from Operations		-	1,533	1,380	1,149	2,723	2,081	-	2,182	2,152	1,752	2,187	772	845	1,048	599	3,265	2,525	2,756	3,003				
Cash from Investing		-	(606)	(172)	(922)	(1,054)	(1,545)	-	(94)	(147)	(146)	(137)	(548)	(146)	(137)	(548)	(607)	(631)	(650)	(650)				
Cash from Financing		-	51	1,997	(744)	(1,807)	(848)	-	(443)	(469)	(468)	(479)	(1,828)	(1,808)	(1,828)	(1,828)	(1,629)	(1,629)	(1,630)	(1,630)				
Capital Expenditures		-	282	229	290	441	354	-	92	50	50	50	372	384	407	434	407	434	407	434				
Capex % of sales		-	1.4%	1.0%	1.0%	1.5%	1.0%	-	1.1%	1.1%	1.1%	1.1%	5.0%	4.4%	4.6%	4.6%	4.6%	4.4%	4.4%	4.4%				
Free Cash Flow		-	1,251	1,141	859	2,282	1,827	-	1,890	1,855	1,556	1,810	624	899	1,041	551	2,858	2,245	2,450	2,572				
Free Cash Flow Conversion		-	13.0%	7.8%	4.0%	7.4%	11.1%	-	91	164%	116%	147%	115%	134%	122%	92%	92%	92%	92%	92%				
Free Cash Flow per Share		-	\$5.51	\$5.07	\$3.92	\$11.01	\$8.26	-	\$4.92	\$4.95	\$4.26	\$4.95	\$2.88	\$4.05	\$4.68	\$4.14	\$11.41	\$8.95	\$9.75	\$10.61				
Dividend Per Share		-	\$145	\$0.46	\$2.51	\$3.41	\$3.38	-	\$0.89	\$0.87	\$0.87	\$0.93	\$3.57	\$3.75	\$3.75	\$3.75	\$3.75	\$3.75	\$3.75	\$3.75				

Source: Company filings, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 29: **Fastenal (FAST)** Financials

BERNSTEIN SOCIETE GENERALE GROUP																
	FY 2019	FY 2020	FY 2021	FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024	Q1'25	Q2'25	Q3'25	Q4'25	FY 2025	Q1'26	Q2'26E	Q3'26E	Q4'26E	FY 2026E
Income Statement																
Net Sales	5,334	5,647	6,011	6,981	7,347	7,546	1,959	2,080	2,133	2,027	8,200	2,202	2,266	2,304	2,190	8,962
Cost of sales	2,818	3,080	3,234	3,765	3,992	4,144	1,076	1,138	1,188	1,129	4,509	1,219	1,251	1,272	1,221	4,963
Gross Profit	2,515	2,568	2,777	3,216	3,355	3,402	884	943	966	899	3,691	983	1,016	1,032	968	3,999
Selling, general, and administrative expenses	1,458	1,426	1,560	1,762	1,826	1,892	490	507	524	514	2,035	535	537	557	547	2,176
Operating Income	1,057	1,142	1,217	1,454	1,529	1,510	394	436	442	384	1,656	448	479	475	422	1,822
EBITDA	1,212	1,310	1,394	1,637	1,713	1,693	441	483	489	431	1,843	495	530	525	472	2,021
Net Interest Expense	-14	-9	-10	-14	-7	-2	-1	1	0	-1	1	1	1	0	1	3
Income before income taxes	1,044	1,133	1,208	1,440	1,522	1,508	393	437	441	385	1,655	448	479	475	423	1,825
Income Taxes	253	274	283	353	367	358	94	106	105	91	396	109	117	113	99	438
Net Income	791	859	925	1,087	1,155	1,151	299	330	336	294	1,259	340	363	362	323	1,387
EPS, Diluted common shareholders	\$0.69	\$0.75	\$0.80	\$0.94	\$1.01	\$1.00	\$0.26	\$0.29	\$0.29	\$0.26	\$1.09	\$0.30	\$0.32	\$0.31	\$0.28	\$1.21
Diluted shares outstanding	1,149	1,151	1,154	1,151	1,146	1,149	1,150	1,150	1,151	1,151	1,150	1,151	1,151	1,151	1,151	1,151
Tax Rate	24.2%	24.2%	23.4%	24.5%	24.1%	23.7%	24.0%	24.3%	23.9%	23.5%	23.9%	24.2%	24.3%	23.9%	23.5%	24.0%
Margin Analysis																
Gross Margin	47.2%	45.5%	46.2%	46.1%	45.7%	45.1%	45.1%	45.3%	45.3%	44.3%	45.0%	44.6%	44.8%	44.8%	44.2%	44.6%
EBIT Margin	19.8%	20.2%	20.3%	20.8%	20.8%	20.0%	20.1%	21.0%	20.7%	19.0%	20.2%	20.3%	21.1%	20.6%	19.3%	20.3%
EBITDA Margin	22.7%	23.2%	23.2%	23.5%	23.3%	22.4%	22.5%	23.2%	22.9%	21.3%	22.5%	22.5%	23.4%	22.8%	21.5%	22.6%
Net Profit Margin	14.8%	15.2%	15.4%	15.6%	15.7%	15.2%	15.2%	15.9%	15.7%	14.5%	15.3%	15.4%	16.0%	15.7%	14.8%	15.5%
Year-on-Year Growth																
Net Sales	7.4%	5.9%	6.4%	16.1%	5.2%	2.7%	3.4%	8.6%	11.7%	11.1%	8.7%	12.4%	8.9%	8.0%	8.0%	9.3%
Gross Profit	4.9%	2.1%	8.2%	15.8%	4.3%	1.4%	2.6%	9.2%	12.5%	9.8%	8.5%	11.2%	7.7%	6.8%	7.8%	8.3%
Operating Income	5.8%	8.0%	6.6%	19.4%	5.2%	-1.2%	0.9%	12.7%	13.8%	11.5%	9.7%	13.6%	9.7%	7.5%	9.7%	10.1%
EBITDA	6.0%	8.1%	6.4%	17.5%	4.6%	-1.2%	1.3%	11.7%	12.5%	10.1%	8.9%	12.3%	9.6%	7.5%	9.5%	9.7%
EPS, Diluted common shareholders	5.2%	8.4%	7.4%	17.8%	6.8%	-0.6%	0.2%	12.7%	12.3%	12.1%	9.2%	13.6%	9.7%	7.8%	9.9%	10.2%
Balance Sheet																
Cash and cash equivalents	175	246	236	230	221	256	232	238	288	277	277	309	133	202	299	299
Total assets	3,800	3,965	4,299	4,549	4,463	4,698	4,871	5,016	5,116	5,053	5,053	5,210	5,342	5,467	5,492	5,492
Total Debt	345	405	390	555	260	200	200	230	195	125	125	125	125	125	125	125
Other liabilities	789	827	867	830	854	882	981	979	1,027	984	984	1,095	1,131	1,160	1,128	1,128
Total shareholders' equity	2,666	2,733	3,042	3,163	3,349	3,616	3,690	3,807	3,895	3,944	3,944	3,990	4,086	4,162	4,239	4,239
Net working capital	1,741	1,681	1,998	2,307	2,198	2,344	2,416	2,534	2,520	2,505	2,505	2,512	2,750	2,740	2,664	2,664
Consolidated Statement of Cash Flows																
Cash from Operations	843	1,102	770	941	1,433	1,333	262	279	387	368	1,296	378	174	419	447	1,419
Cash from Investing	(240)	(282)	(149)	(163)	(161)	(215)	(54)	(64)	(55)	(58)	(231)	(58)	(64)	(83)	(310)	(310)
Cash from Financing	(595)	(754)	(827)	(775)	(1,283)	(914)	(218)	(281)	(325)	(266)	(1,055)	(286)	(286)	(266)	(1,086)	(899)
Capital Expenditures	246	168	157	174	173	227	56	69	60	60	245	59	84	85	83	311
Capex % of sales	4.6%	3.0%	2.6%	2.5%	2.4%	3.0%	2.8%	3.3%	2.8%	3.0%	3.0%	2.7%	3.7%	3.7%	3.8%	3.5%
Free Cash Flow	596	934	614	767	1,260	947	207	209	327	308	1,051	320	90	334	364	1,108
Free Cash Flow Conversion	75%	109%	66%	71%	109%	82%	69%	63%	97%	105%	83%	94%	25%	92%	113%	80%
Free Cash Flow per Share	\$0.52	\$0.81	\$0.53	\$0.67	\$1.10	\$0.82	\$0.18	\$0.18	\$0.28	\$0.27	\$0.91	\$0.28	\$0.08	\$0.29	\$0.32	\$0.96
Dividend Per Share	\$0.44	\$0.70	\$0.56	\$0.62	\$0.89	\$0.78	\$0.21	\$0.22	\$0.22	\$0.22	\$0.87	\$0.00	\$0.23	\$0.23	\$0.23	\$0.69

Source: Company filings, Bernstein analysis

EXHIBIT 30: **W. W. Grainger (GWW)** Financials

BERNSTEIN																			
SOCIETE GENERALE GROUP																			
	FY 2019	FY 2020	FY 2021	FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024	Q1'25	Q2'25	Q3'25	Q4'25	FY 2025	Q1'26	Q2'26E	Q3'26E	Q4'26E	FY 2026E	FY 2027E	FY 2028E	FY 2029E
Income Statement																			
Net Sales	11,486	11,797	13,022	15,228	16,478	17,168	4,306	4,554	4,657	4,425	17,942	4,742	4,942	4,989	4,648	19,338	20,354	21,477	22,675
Cost of Goods Sold	7,089	7,559	8,302	9,379	9,982	10,410	2,596	2,799	2,859	2,679	10,933	2,846	3,037	3,029	2,803	11,715	12,368	13,100	13,868
Gross Profit	4,397	4,238	4,720	5,849	6,496	6,758	1,710	1,755	1,798	1,746	7,009	1,896	1,922	1,960	1,845	7,622	7,986	8,377	8,797
Selling, General and Administrative expenses	3,135	3,219	3,173	3,634	3,931	4,121	1,038	1,077	1,287	1,112	4,514	1,103	1,150	1,154	1,140	4,546	4,717	4,903	5,094
Operating Income (Recurring)	1,388	1,327	1,547	2,194	2,591	2,653	672	678	707	634	2,491	793	772	806	705	3,077	3,269	3,474	3,697
Adjusted EBITDA	1,657	1,555	1,774	2,459	2,867	2,952	745	765	786	713	3,009	869	865	889	787	3,411	3,618	3,838	4,078
Net Interest Expense (Income)	79	93	87	93	93	77	21	20	20	20	81	21	19	18	17	74	55	24	-16
Income before income taxes (Recurring)	1,335	1,255	1,485	2,125	2,526	2,600	657	661	688	620	2,626	775	758	792	692	3,017	3,230	3,466	3,739
Income Taxes	314	192	371	533	597	595	157	153	171	141	622	194	189	198	173	755	807	866	932
Net Income (Recurring)	959	876	1,042	1,526	1,851	1,925	479	482	490	451	1,902	555	541	567	492	2,156	2,294	2,439	2,637
EPS, Diluted (Recurring)	\$17.31	\$16.18	\$19.82	\$29.67	\$36.67	\$38.96	\$9.86	\$9.97	\$10.21	\$9.44	\$38.48	\$11.65	\$11.47	\$12.08	\$10.53	\$45.72	\$48.63	\$53.77	\$59.25
Diluted shares outstanding	55	54	52	51	50	50	48	48	48	48	48	47	47	47	47	47	46	45	45
Tax Rate (Adjusted)	24.7%	25.4%	25.0%	25.1%	23.8%	22.9%	23.9%	23.1%	24.9%	22.7%	23.7%	25.0%	25.0%	25.0%	25.0%	25.0%	25.0%	25.0%	25.0%
Margin Analysis																			
Gross Margin	38.3%	35.9%	36.2%	38.4%	39.4%	39.4%	39.7%	38.5%	38.6%	39.5%	39.1%	40.0%	38.8%	39.3%	39.7%	39.4%	39.2%	39.0%	38.8%
EBIT Margin	12.1%	11.2%	11.9%	14.4%	15.7%	15.5%	15.6%	14.9%	15.2%	14.3%	15.0%	16.7%	15.6%	16.2%	15.2%	15.9%	16.1%	16.2%	16.3%
EBITDA Margin	14.4%	13.2%	13.6%	16.1%	17.4%	17.2%	17.3%	16.8%	16.9%	16.1%	16.8%	18.3%	17.4%	17.8%	16.9%	17.6%	17.8%	17.9%	18.0%
Net Profit Margin	8.3%	7.4%	8.0%	10.0%	11.2%	11.2%	11.1%	10.6%	10.5%	10.2%	10.6%	11.7%	10.9%	11.4%	10.6%	11.1%	11.3%	11.4%	11.6%
Year-on-Year Growth																			
Net Sales	2.4%	2.7%	10.4%	16.9%	8.2%	4.2%	1.7%	5.6%	6.1%	4.5%	4.5%	10.1%	8.9%	7.1%	5.0%	7.8%	5.3%	5.5%	5.6%
Gross Profit	1.1%	-3.6%	11.4%	23.9%	11.1%	4.0%	2.5%	3.6%	4.5%	4.2%	3.7%	10.9%	9.5%	9.0%	5.7%	8.8%	4.8%	4.9%	4.9%
Operating Income (Recurring)	3.2%	-4.4%	16.6%	41.8%	18.1%	2.4%	0.4%	2.0%	3.1%	0.2%	1.4%	18.0%	13.9%	14.0%	11.2%	14.3%	6.3%	6.3%	6.4%
Adjusted EBITDA	0.5%	-6.1%	14.1%	38.6%	16.6%	3.0%	1.2%	2.3%	3.6%	0.6%	1.9%	16.6%	13.1%	13.2%	10.4%	13.4%	6.4%	6.4%	6.4%
EPS, Diluted (Recurring)	3.4%	-6.5%	22.5%	49.7%	23.6%	6.3%	2.5%	2.2%	3.5%	-3.2%	1.3%	18.2%	15.0%	18.3%	11.5%	15.8%	8.6%	8.3%	10.2%
Balance Sheet																			
Cash and cash equivalents	360	585	241	325	660	1,036	666	597	535	585	585	695	674	840	816	816	1,392	2,234	3,246
Total assets	6,005	6,295	6,592	7,588	8,147	8,729	8,658	8,937	8,848	8,962	8,962	9,473	9,790	9,926	9,935	9,935	10,964	12,136	13,506
Total Debt	2,215	2,397	2,362	2,319	2,300	2,278	2,281	2,343	2,369	2,488	2,488	2,411	2,411	2,411	2,411	2,411	2,411	2,411	2,411
Other liabilities	1,730	1,805	2,070	2,534	2,406	2,348	2,530	2,511	2,518	2,333	2,333	2,719	2,810	2,756	2,609	2,609	2,707	2,817	2,935
Total shareholders' equity	1,855	1,849	1,874	2,440	3,115	3,358	3,480	3,674	3,561	3,736	3,736	3,930	4,156	4,345	4,502	4,502	5,433	6,495	7,741
Net working capital	1,818	1,901	2,242	2,677	2,871	2,895	2,850	3,053	2,926	3,085	3,085	3,015	3,141	3,084	3,193	3,193	3,372	3,569	3,778
Consolidated Statement of Cash Flows																			
Cash from Operations	1,042	1,123	937	1,333	2,031	2,111	646	577	597	395	2,015	739	508	708	465	2,420	2,464	2,607	2,806
Cash from Investing	(202)	(179)	(226)	(263)	(422)	(520)	(125)	(188)	(227)	(102)	(645)	(101)	(101)	(150)	(159)	(658)	(456)	(222)	(341)
Cash from Financing	(1,023)	(726)	(1,039)	(1,272)	(1,728)	(1,180)	(898)	(903)	(398)	(226)	(1,825)	(446)	(338)	(392)	(350)	(1,526)	(1,430)	(1,443)	(1,456)
Capital Expenditures	221	197	255	256	445	541	128	175	258	126	684	170	191	150	139	650	458	322	340
Capex % of sales	1.9%	1.7%	2.0%	1.7%	2.7%	3.2%	2.9%	3.8%	5.5%	2.8%	3.8%	3.6%	3.8%	3.0%	3.0%	3.4%	2.2%	1.5%	1.5%
Free Cash Flow	821	926	682	1,077	1,586	1,570	521	202	339	269	1,331	569	317	558	326	1,770	2,006	2,285	2,468
Free Cash Flow Conversion	97%	133%	95%	70%	97%	92%	12%	4%	7%	42%	115%	130%	98%	98%	116%	100%	94%	94%	94%
Free Cash Flow per Share	\$14.55	\$17.24	\$13.07	\$21.08	\$31.66	\$31.34	\$10.79	\$4.20	\$7.08	\$5.65	\$27.73	\$12.00	\$6.72	\$11.88	\$6.97	\$37.60	\$43.41	\$50.37	\$55.46
Dividend Per Share	\$5.68	\$5.94	\$6.39	\$6.78	\$7.30	\$8.01	\$2.05	\$2.26	\$2.05	\$2.10	\$8.46	\$2.05	\$2.37	\$2.15	\$2.21	\$8.78	\$9.22	\$9.68	\$10.17

BERNSTEIN		SOCIÉTÉ GÉNÉRALE GROUP																																											
				FY 2019		FY 2020		FY 2021		FY 2022		FY 2023		FY 2024		FY 2025		FY 2026		FY 2027		FY 2028		FY 2029																					
Income Statement																																													
Net Sales				2,015		2,161		2,424		2,696		3,073		3,389		3,823		4,000		1,026		913		3,761		906		1,098		1,122		999		4,126		4,505		4,920		5,373					
Cost of services provided (ex-D&A)				1,949		1,049		1,163		1,308		1,470		1,603		400		462		467		448		1,777		444		1,777		444		504		508		487		1,944		2,112		2,299		2,503	
Gross Profit				624		1,113		1,262		1,387		1,593		1,786		422		538		539		465		1,884		461		1,884		461		594		581		515		2,161		2,393		2,617		2,871	
Selling and administrative expenses				623		656		727		803		915		1,015		251		308		301		274		1,133		283		337		332		299		1,250		1,356		1,474		1,601					
Depreciation and amortization				81		88		94		91		100		113		29		32		32		32		125		32		37		38		33		140		151		164		180					
Operating Income (Recurring)				324		388		453		491		604		675		147		206		232		167		752		153		228		252		188		820		916		1,012		1,119					
Adjusted EBITDA				399		455		543		593		693		770		231		231		232		198		862		178		257		283		224		932		1,044		1,147		1,291					
Interest expense, net				5		5		1		3		19		28		6		7		8		7		29		9		8		9		7		33		28		21		12					
Income before income taxes				261		355		475		499		586		630		138		191		217		155		701		137		212		236		173		758		859		962		1,078					
Income Tax				94		98		94		94		104		164		324		530		544		384		174		54		54		57		140		281		241		281		304					
Net Income (Recurring)				233		261		344		387		436		479		108		148		170		121		547		113		166		186		136		600		673		751		838					
EPS, Diluted (Recurring)				\$0.47		\$0.53		\$0.70		\$0.78		\$0.99		\$0.72		\$0.21		\$0.31		\$0.35		\$0.25		\$1.13		\$0.24		\$0.34		\$0.39		\$0.28		\$1.25		\$1.40		\$1.55		\$1.73					
Diluted shares outstanding				491		492		492		492		490		484		484		485		485		483		484		481		482		482		482		482		482		483		484					
Tax Rate				22.1%		26.5%		26.1%		26.1%		25.8%		26.0%		23.5%		26.0%		24.8%		24.7%		24.9%		21.3%		25.2%		24.3%		28.0%		24.5%		25.0%		25.3%							
Margin Analysis																																													
Gross Margin				50.7%		51.5%		52.0%		51.5%		52.2%		52.7%		51.4%		53.8%		54.4%		51.0%		52.8%		50.8%		54.1%		54.7%		51.3%		52.9%		53.1%		53.3%		53.4%					
EBIT Margin				16.1%		17.0%		18.7%		18.2%		19.7%		19.9%		17.9%		20.6%		22.6%		18.3%		20.0%		16.9%		20.8%		20.8%		22.5%		18.8%		19.9%									

EXHIBIT 32: **Cintas (CTAS) Financials**

BERNSTEIN SOCIETEC FINANCIAL GROUP		Consolidated Statement of Cash Flows																																
		FY 2018							FY 2019							FY 2020							FY 2021							FY 2022				
Income Statement		FY 2018	FY 2019	FY 2020	FY 2021	FY 2022	FY 2023	FY 2024	FY 2025	Q1'26	Q2'26	Q3'26	Q4'26	FY 2026E	Q1'27E	Q2'27E	Q3'27E	Q4'27E	FY 2028E	FY 2029E	FY 2030E	FY 2031E	FY 2032E	FY 2033E	FY 2034E	FY 2035E	FY 2036E	FY 2037E						
Net Sales		6,477	6,892	7,085	7,116	7,854	8,816	9,597	10,340	2,718	2,800	2,841	2,871	11,231	2,890	2,977	3,020	3,052	11,938	12,692	13,495													
Cost of Goods Sold		3,568	3,764	3,851	3,802	4,222	4,642	4,910	5,166	1,352	1,389	1,393	1,434	5,566	1,431	1,469	1,475	1,513	5,888	6,204	6,538													
Gross Profit		2,909	3,129	3,234	3,315	3,632	4,174	4,686	5,174	1,367	1,412	1,448	1,437	5,665	1,458	1,507	1,545	1,539	6,050	6,488	6,957													
Selling and administrative expenses		1,917	1,981	2,071	1,929	2,045	2,371	2,618	2,814	749	757	789	782	3,076	793	801	835	828	3,257	3,449	3,653													
Operating Income		950	1,134	1,163	1,385	1,587	1,803	2,069	2,360	618	656	660	660	655	2,589	666	706	710	711	2,793	3,038	3,304												
EBITDA		1,229	1,404	1,542	1,773	1,987	2,212	2,511	2,854	744	783	789	787	3,102	800	842	847	851	3,339	3,610	3,920													
Interest expense		110	102	105	98	89	111	101	101	24	28	28	28	24	105	22	21	18	13	73	28	-27												
Income before income taxes		841	1,102	1,058	1,288	1,499	1,693	1,974	2,264	596	629	632	631	2,488	644	685	693	698	2,720	3,011	3,331													
Income Taxes		57	220	182	177	263	345	422	452	105	133	130	129	489	131	145	142	143	544	602	666													
EPS, Diluted common shareholders		831	975	968	1,103	1,230	1,343	1,568	1,806	489	502	502	502	1,988	531	540	550	555	2,176	2,400	2,660													
EPS, Diluted common shareholders		\$1.89	\$2.00	\$2.03	\$2.56	\$2.91	\$3.25	\$3.79	\$4.40	\$1.20	\$1.21	\$1.24	\$1.24	\$4.89	\$1.31	\$1.33	\$1.37	\$1.38	\$5.40	\$6.03	\$6.73													
Diluted shares outstanding		439	438	428	431	422	414	413	410	409	406	405	405	406	404	406	402	401	403	400	396													
Tax Rate		6.8%	19.9%	17.2%	13.7%	17.5%	20.2%	20.4%	20.0%	17.6%	21.2%	20.6%	20.5%	20.5%	20.0%	17.6%	21.2%	20.6%	20.5%	20.0%	20.0%													
Margin Analysis																																		
Gross Margin		44.9%	45.4%	45.6%	46.6%	46.2%	47.3%	48.8%	50.0%	50.3%	50.4%	51.0%	50.1%	50.4%	50.5%	50.6%	51.2%	50.4%	50.7%	51.1%	51.6%													
EBIT Margin		14.7%	16.4%	16.4%	19.5%	20.2%	20.4%	21.6%	22.8%	22.7%	23.4%	23.2%	22.8%	23.1%	23.0%	23.7%	23.8%	23.3%	23.4%	23.9%	24.5%													
EBITDA Margin		18.0%	21.7%	21.6%	24.9%	25.3%	25.1%	26.2%	27.6%	27.2%	28.0%	27.7%	27.6%	27.9%	27.7%	28.3%	28.0%	27.9%	28.0%	28.5%	29.1%													
Incremental Margin (Estimated)		22.5%	63.0%	25.0%	74.2%	28.9%	23.4%	38.3%	46.1%	51.2%	25.9%	32.7%	32.9%	27.9%	32.5%	33.1%	32.8%	35.4%	37.7%	37.1%	37.6%													
Net Profit Margin		12.8%	12.7%	12.2%	15.5%	15.7%	15.2%	16.3%	17.5%	18.0%	17.6%	17.7%	17.5%	17.7%	17.8%	18.4%	18.1%	18.2%	18.2%	18.2%	19.0%	19.7%												
Year-on-Year Growth																																		
Net Sales		21.7%	6.4%	2.8%	0.4%	10.4%	12.2%	8.9%	7.7%	8.7%	9.3%	8.9%	7.6%	8.6%	6.3%	6.3%	6.3%	6.3%	6.3%	6.3%	6.3%													
Gross Profit		22.2%	7.6%	3.4%	2.5%	9.6%	14.9%	12.3%	10.4%	9.1%	10.6%	9.8%	8.4%	9.5%	6.7%	6.7%	6.7%	7.1%	6.8%	7.2%	7.2%													
Operating Income		22.8%	19.3%	2.6%	19.2%	14.6%	13.6%	14.8%	14.1%	10.1%	10.9%	8.2%	9.7%	9.7%	7.7%	7.7%	7.7%	8.5%	7.9%	8.8%	8.7%													
EBITDA		26.7%	21.5%	3.2%	15.0%	12.0%	11.3%	13.5%	13.7%	10.0%	8.6%	7.0%	9.4%	8.7%	7.5%	7.5%	7.4%	8.1%	7.6%	8.4%	8.3%													
EPS, Diluted common shareholders		72.6%	5.7%	1.4%	26.3%	13.7%	11.5%	16.7%	16.2%	9.0%	11.6%	10.3%	13.7%	11.2%	9.9%	9.6%	10.3%	11.5%	10.3%	11.6%	11.6%													
Balance Sheet																																		
Cash and cash equivalents		139	97	145	494	90	124	342	264	138	201	183	728	728	738	912	1,277	1,644	1,644	2,763	4,110													
Total assets		6,958	7,437	7,670	8,237	8,147	8,546	9,169	9,825	9,838	10,133	10,234	10,793	10,873	10,829	11,066	11,456	11,826	11,826	13,068	14,547													
Total debt		2,535	2,850	2,540	2,542	2,796	2,486	2,426	2,425	2,426	2,977	2,657	2,657	2,657	2,657	2,657	2,657	2,657	2,657	2,657	2,657													
Other liabilities		1,406	1,584	1,895	2,007	2,044	2,196	2,377	2,716	2,656	2,700	2,789	3,031	3,031	2,896	2,953	2,958	3,116	3,116	3,194	3,287													
Total shareholders' equity		3,017	3,003	3,235	3,688	3,306	3,684	4,166	4,484	4,456	4,456	4,456	4,456	4,456	4,456	4,456	4,456	4,456	4,456	4,456	4,456													
Net working capital		1,063	1,324	1,279	1,315	1,424	1,584	1,464	1,528	1,730	1,814	1,832	1,612	1,612	1,798	1,827	1,887	1,741	1,741	1,989	2,087													
Consolidated Statement of Cash Flows																																		
Cash from Operations		964	1,068	1,291	1,361	1,538	1,598	2,080	2,166	414	531	621	884	2,451	509	679	661	871	2,720	2,974	3,257													
Cash from Investing		(136)	(236)	(285)	(137)	(403)	(389)	(609)	(624)	(116)	(103)	(101)	(123)	(534)	(108)	(113)	(97)	(131)	(449)	(477)	(508)													
Cash from Financing		(864)	(873)	(955)	(880)	(1,538)	(1,173)	(1,263)	(1,619)	(424)	(275)	(540)	(216)	(1,455)	(391)	(392)	(200)	(372)	(1,355)	(1,378)	(1,401)													
Capital Expenditures		272	277	230	143	241	331	409	400	102	106	102	102	422	108	113	97	131	449	477	508													
Capex % of sales		4.2%	4.0%	3.2%	2.0%	3.1%	3.8%	4.3%	4.0%	3.8%	3.8%	3.2%	4.3%	3.8%	3.8%	3.8%	3.2%	4.3%	3.8%	3.8%	3.8%													
Free Cash Flow		692	791	1,061	1,217	1,297	1,267	1,670	1,757	313	425	531	761	2,029	400	566	565	740	2,271	2,496	2,748													
Free Cash Flow Conversion		62.4%	89.5%	12.1%	11.0%	10.5%	9.4%	10.6%	9.7%	64.6%	86.6%	106.6%	152.6%	102.7%	75.0%	105.5%	103.6%	133.6%	104.4%	104.6%	103.6%													
Free Cash Flow Per Share		\$1.58	\$1.81	\$2.48	\$2.83	\$3.07	\$3.04	\$4.28	\$4.57	\$0.76	\$1.05	\$1.29	\$1.88	\$5.48	\$1.03	\$1.46	\$1.45	\$1.98	\$6.03	\$6.66	\$7.31													
Dividend Per Share		\$0.41	\$0.51	\$0.64	\$1.07	\$0.90	\$1.10	\$1.30	\$1.51	\$0.45	\$0.45	\$0.45	\$0.45	\$1.31	\$0.47	\$0.47	\$0.47	\$0.47	\$1.44	\$1.54	\$1.52													

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DISCLOSURE APPENDIX

I. REQUIRED DISCLOSURES

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